

SUCCESS STORY

Total Wine & More



Total Wine & More propels digital growth with reviews

A highly regulated alcohol industry presents unique challenges for retailers of wine, beer, and spirits. These businesses face a variety of limitations and restrictions that slow digital growth in the space. Additionally, a majority of alcohol sales occur in store, making it even more difficult for these retailers to succeed online. Regardless, consumers shopping for all types of products want to know what other consumers think about products before buying.

Leading retailers like Total Wine & More meet this demand by giving online shoppers access to the kind of content they trust. Reviews and other forms of consumer-generated content provide online shoppers with a positive experience, which increases online orders.

REVIEWS TURN SHOPPERS INTO BUYERS

Total Wine & More, the largest independent retailer of fine wine, beer, and spirits in the U.S., uses a variety of tactics to collect reviews, which boosts conversion across hundreds of products and brands in the retailer's catalog.

The retailer saw an 82% lift in conversion and 35% lift in revenue per visitor among those who engaged with reviews compared to those who didn't in 2018. The company also reported a 30% increase in digital sales as a direct result of year-over-year increases in review volume.

AT A GLANCE

Challenge

Increase online traffic and sales in a competitive, highly-regulated industry.

Solution

Use reviews from customers to compel shoppers to buy and provide search engines with fresh, keyword-rich content.

Benefit

Significant lifts in conversion rate, sales, organic traffic, and other site performance metrics.

Featured Solutions



Ratings & Reviews

30%

INCREASE IN DIGITAL
SALES AS A DIRECT
RESULT OF YEAR-OVER-
YEAR INCREASES IN
REVIEW VOLUME

A significant portion of the total review volume is sourced directly from brands. Total Wine & More currently collects content from 29 brands within the Bazaarvoice Network of more than 6,000 brand and retail sites. The syndicated reviews from brands account for 44% of the more than 106,000 total reviews on the retailer's site.

SEO, ORGANIC TRAFFIC, AND SITE ENGAGEMENT INCREASE WITH VOLUME

The reviews also provide Total Wine & More with a substantial amount of fresh, keyword-rich content on product pages, which improves the retailer's search results and keeps visitors on the site longer.

"Adding more reviews to our site has played a significant role in our search rankings. Organic traffic is now the major entry channel to our site," said Bizu Hodge, Digital Marketing Manager at Total Wine & More.

The retailer saw an 80% increase in organic traffic to product pages in 2018 compared to 2017 by steadily gathering more reviews and optimizing how the content is displayed on the site. This serves as a low-cost way to win new customers, as 93% of the visitors in 2018 were first-time visitors to the site.

"Organic traffic is the most cost-effective way to acquire new customers on our site," said Hodge. "Additionally, the traffic and quality of the reviews increased site engagement, and the bounce rate on our product detail pages dropped by 15% this past year."

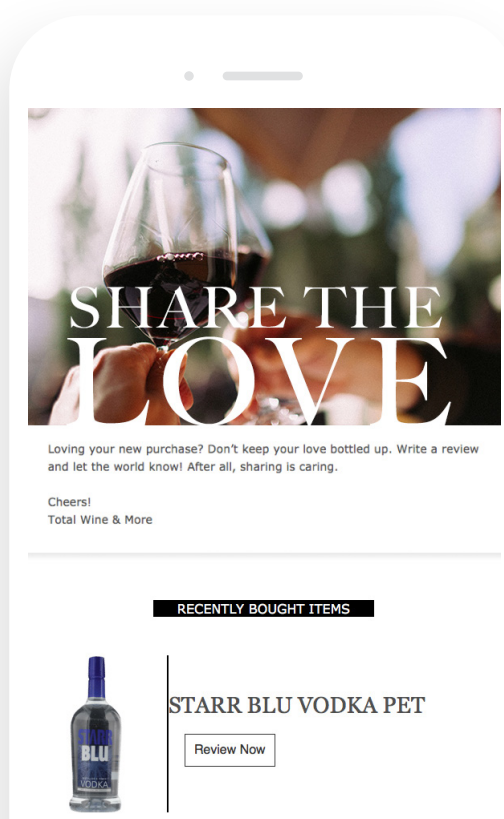
Ultimately, all of these benefits derived from reviews allowed the company to spend 30% less in 2018 than originally planned.



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Bizu Hodge

Digital Marketing Manager
Total Wine & More



COMPANY PROFILE

Food and Beverage

CLIENT SINCE

2012

ABOUT THE COMPANY

Total Wine & More is America's largest independent retailer of fine wine, beer, and spirits with more than 193 superstores across 23 states.

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